Atlanta Botanical Garden - Expansion

Anisacanthus quadrifidus var. *wrightii

Texas firecracker, Flame acanthus, Desert honeysuckle, Hummingbird bush

Family: Acanthaceae



HABIT



OTHER



OTHER



FLOWER

QUICK FACTS

Plant Type: Shrub

Evergreen or deciduous
Deciduous

Growth & Size
Rate: Not stated
Size: 3–5 ft (0.9–1.5 m) tall × 3–4 ft (0.9–1.2 m) wide.
Upright, spreading, informal habit

Sun

Water

Soil
Medium to dry, well-drained. Adaptable to poor, rocky, clay, caliche, limestone, sand. Tolerates alkaline. Wide soil range

Zone 8a
Hardy in Zones 7–10. Suitable for Atlanta Zone 8a. In colder winters may die back to roots and regrow.
Excellent heat and drought tolerance

PLANTING NOTES

Establishment
Low maintenance. Prune for shape in fall or cut back severely every few years. In colder parts of range (Zone 7), dies to ground and re-emerges from roots. Cut to ground in late fall in some regions for denser spring growth. Takes well to pots

ORIGIN AND CHARACTERISTICS

Origin
Native to south-central Texas and adjacent northern Mexico. Rocky slopes, floodplains, shrublands

Form
Deciduous shrub. Upright to spreading. Can be sheared into a denser hedge. Informal appearance.
Popular for hummingbird gardens. Self-seeds potential

Foliage
Simple, opposite, lance-shaped to narrow leaves, light to medium green, somewhat sparse. Medium texture

Flowers and fruit
Reddish-orange to bright red-orange, tubular, trumpet-shaped flowers ~2 in long. Solitary or in short spikes. Bloom June–September/October. Attracts hummingbirds and butterflies

Bark
Exfoliating bark noted on species. Pale

HEALTH

Health
Virtually disease and pest free. Deer-resistant. Salt-tolerant. No serious problems stated. May be browsed by rabbits or mammals in some areas

Symptoms
None stated